great focus now. We are establishing our relations with a new government and the tripartite nature of that government. But we do have I think a better understanding of the scope of the problem and its seriousness.

Specifically, the presence of the Taliban and the tribal realities on the border and the global al-Qaeda operations that are all existing in one area in the Federally Administrated Tribal Areas on the one point pinpoints the problem. We know where it is. The question is, What do we do about it? I have a sense that the problem with regard to Afghanistan and, in fact, the region, could be migrating east. That is not a good thing. We certainly want Pakistan to be a free and democratic state. But I am troubled by the fact that the largest proportional increase in suicide bombings is in fact in Pakistan now, not in Afghanistan nor in Iraq. And usually that is the precursor of worrisome things.

I have done a little research on the aid question. WE do have $655 million in AID money, as *Ambassador Holbrooke* mentioned. We also have the Department of Defense and the Pakistani Government, they have each committed $1 billion toward the Pakistan military's operations in the FATA. Also the development of the Frontier Corps, Special Forces training and education, and the establishment of border coordination centers which I think will represent something that has been needed for quite a while.

We have spent money in Pakistan. Coalition support funds between October 2001 and now amount to $5.6 billion. But these coalition support funds do not just exist in Pakistan, they also exist in 27 other countries. And we also have also other forms of assistance, particularly in security assistance which amount to over $300 million a year.

So I think we have a realization nationally that this is a strategic problem, that it is regional in scope, and you cannot solve one without solving the other. I think one of the aspects of the solution is to get the Government of Pakistan and the new Government— I am sorry, the new Government of Pakistan and the Karzai government in Afghanistan to work together more closely on this common problem. For two long, at least in my active duty days, there was too much finger pointing between the two and not enough cooperation. We participated in a tripartite coordination council which is a council of militaries involving NATO, involving Afghanistan and Pakistan; that was generally a good thing. My last experience had to do with watching the strategy of the Musharraf government which signed this deal with the tribal areas but which collapsed, as *Ambassador Holbrooke* said, in failure. But it took—it had to run itself out to prove the point that this was not a strategy that had a long-term solution.

So I hope that the regional aspect of this very important problem, the focus on the geographic location that has to be dealt with, and the resources that will be required not just from us but from the international communities in order to do this can altogether turn the direction of the region in a positive way.

I look forward to responding to your questions. Thank you.

Chairman Berman. I am just looking at the monitor of the floor votes to try and understand where we are.

Let me ask you, *Ambassador Holbrooke*, you have to leave here at 12 o'clock.
Ambassador Holbrooke. 12:00.
Chairman Berman. Ambassador Pickring, 11:00?

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